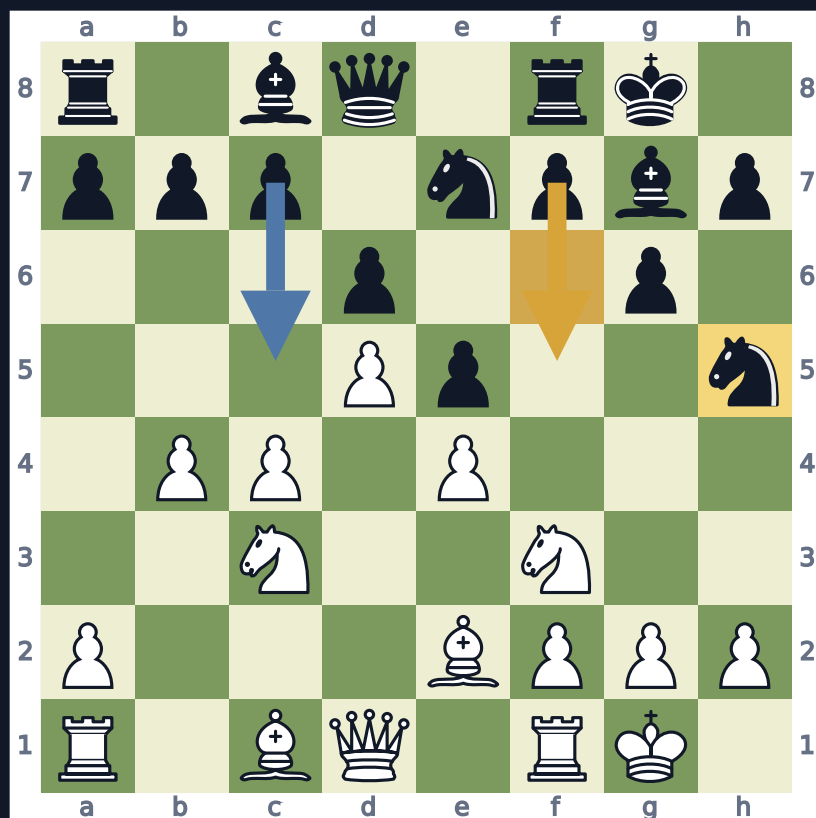


05

The Bayonet Attack and Queenside Expansion

Meet 9.b4 without panic and understand what ...Nh5 accomplishes



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Decode White's fastest space grab and Black's counterplay against its timing and hooks.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 025 | PAGE 4

*Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.***Decode: The Nh5 response**

LESSON 026 | PAGE 8

*Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.***Play: The Nh5 response**

LESSON 027 | PAGE 12

*Evaluate the recapture by the next two useful moves.***Decode: The capture on f5**

LESSON 028 | PAGE 16

*Evaluate the recapture by the next two useful moves.***Play: The capture on f5**

LESSON 029 | PAGE 20

*A flank break is justified by the line it opens for a piece.***Decode: The a-file transformation**

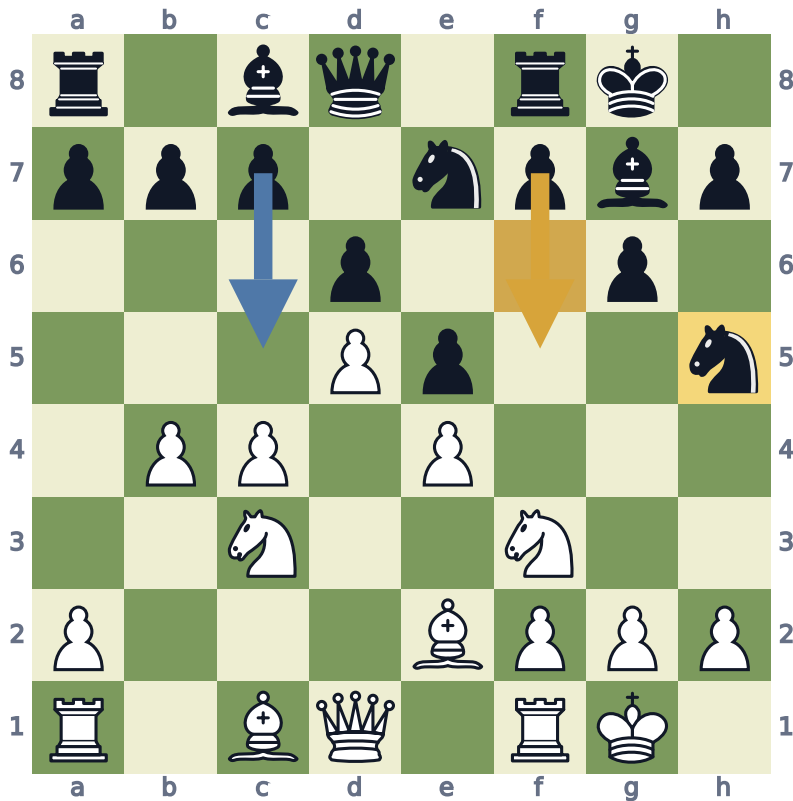
LESSON 030 | PAGE 24

*A flank break is justified by the line it opens for a piece.***Play: The a-file transformation****VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

Decode White's fastest space grab and Black's counterplay against its timing and hooks.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The Nh5 response

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

...Nh5 clears the f-pawn, eyes f4, and keeps the e7-knight available while White has committed to b4.

DECISION RULE

Test whether ...f5 or ...c6 must come first in the exact move order.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Challenge with ...f5 and use ...c6 when it strikes White's center or b5 support.

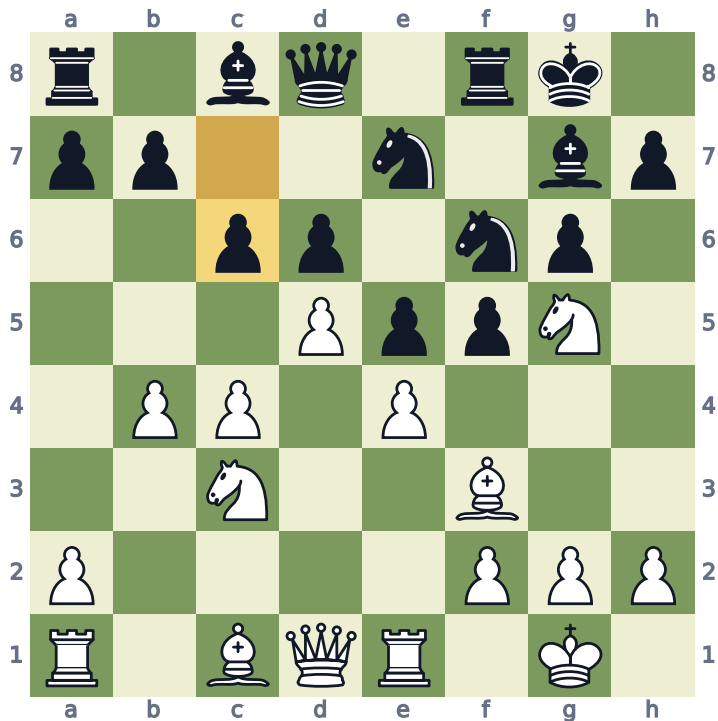
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants c5, a4, and a queenside breakthrough before Black organizes.

MEMORY RULE | Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Nh5 clears the f-pawn, eyes f4, and keeps the e7-knight available while White has committed to b4.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Challenge with ...f5 and use ...c6 when it strikes White's center or b5 support.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White wants c5, a4, and a queenside breakthrough before Black organizes.

FAILURE MODE

Repeating a memorized order can allow e5 or Ne6 tactics.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Test whether ...f5 or ...c6 must come first in the exact move order. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

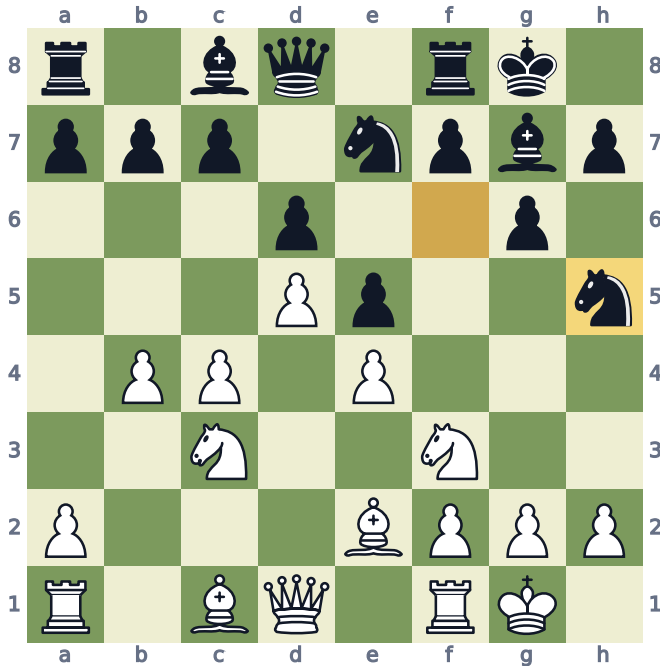
RULE | Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. Re1 f5 11. Ng5 Nf6 12. Bf3 c6



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight toward c6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ne7: Black reroutes a knight toward e7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- b4: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Nh5: Black reroutes a knight toward h5; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nh5 clears the f-pawn, eyes f4, and keeps the e7-knight available while White has committed to b4.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Test whether ...f5 or ...c6 must come first in the exact move order. White's resistance is: White wants c5, a4, and a queenside breakthrough before Black organizes. The line fails as a template when: Repeating a memorized order can allow e5 or Ne6 tactics.

STORE THIS | Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

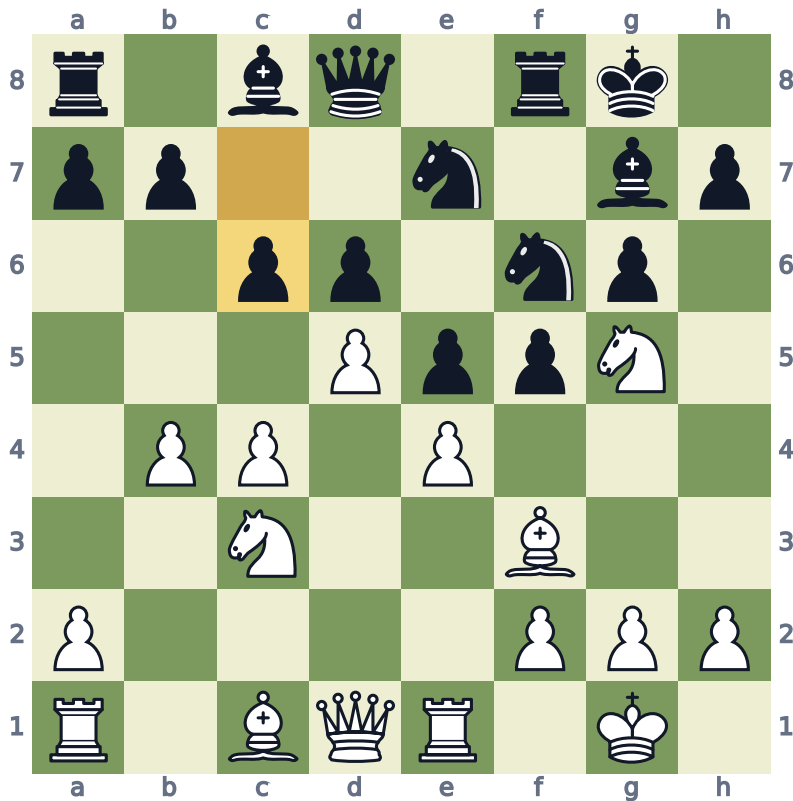
1. ...Nh5 clears the f-pawn, eyes f4, and keeps the e7-knight available while White has committed to b4. 2. Challenge with ...f5 and use ...c6 when it strikes White's center or b5 support. 3. White wants c5, a4, and a queenside breakthrough before Black organizes. 4. Test whether ...f5 or ...c6 must come first in the exact move order. 5. Repeating a memorized order can allow e5 or Ne6 tactics.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The Nh5 response



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Nh5 clears the f-pawn, eyes f4, and keeps the e7-knight available while White has committed to b4.

DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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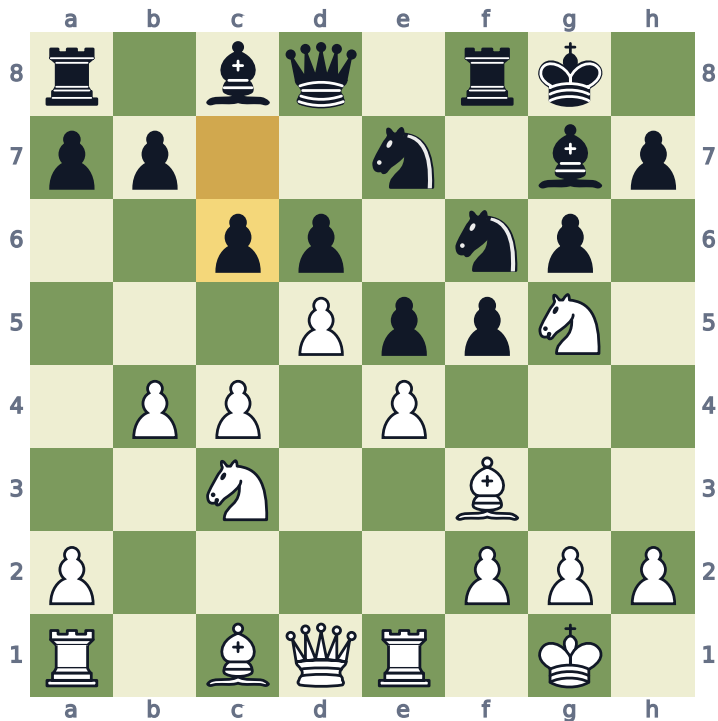
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The plan map



CUE

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BLACK AIMS FOR

Challenge with ...f5 and use ...c6 when it strikes White's center or b5 support.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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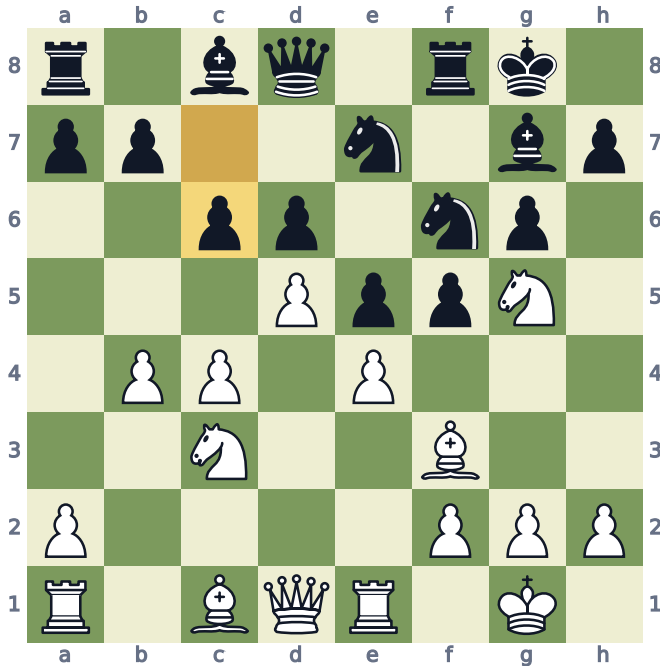
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- Re1: White places a rook on a line expected to open or uses it to support a central transformation.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.
- Ng5: White reroutes a knight toward g5; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight toward f6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Bf3: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- c6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nh5 clears the f-pawn, eyes f4, and keeps the e7-knight available while White has committed to b4.

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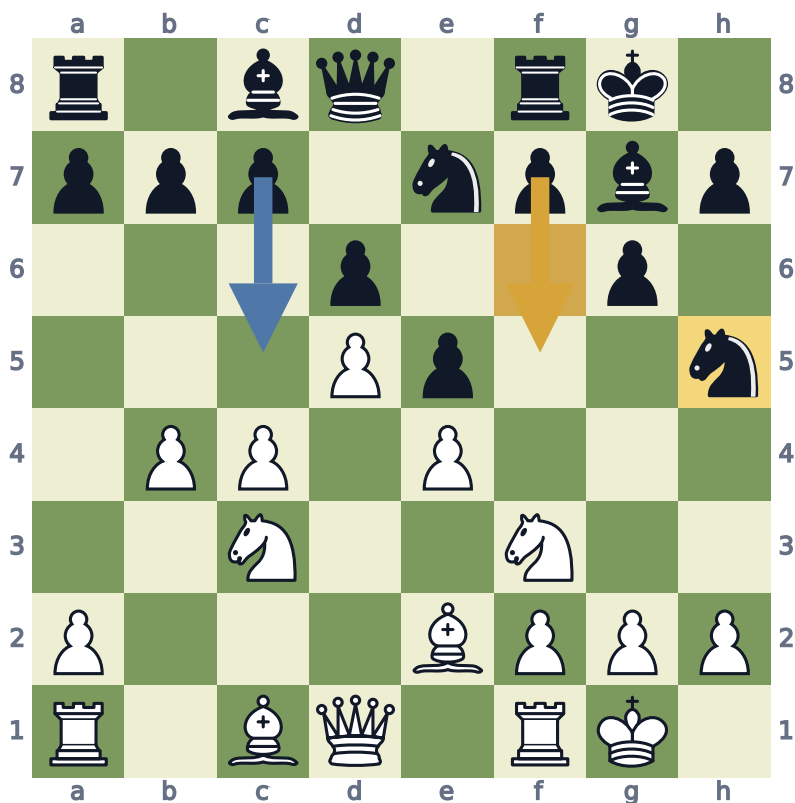
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. Re1 f5 11. Ng5 Nf6 12. Bf3 c6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The capture on f5

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

White can clarify f5 to slow the pawn roller, but the recapture activates Black's dark bishop and changes e4 pressure.

DECISION RULE

Compare ...Bxf5 with other recaptures by activity, king safety, and control of e4.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use the active bishop, contest e4, and avoid overextending before development catches up.

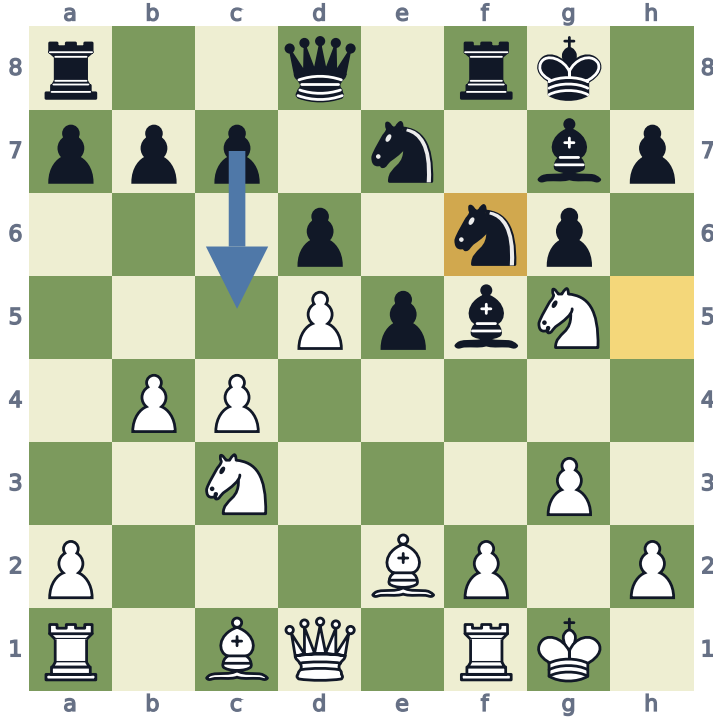
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks g4, Ne6, or queenside play while the bishop is exposed.

MEMORY RULE | Evaluate the recapture by the next two useful moves.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White can clarify f5 to slow the pawn roller, but the recapture activates Black's dark bishop and changes e4 pressure.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use the active bishop, contest e4, and avoid overextending before development catches up.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

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FAILURE MODE

A visually active bishop can become a tempo target if Black has no follow-up.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Compare ...Bxf5 with other recaptures by activity, king safety, and control of e4. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

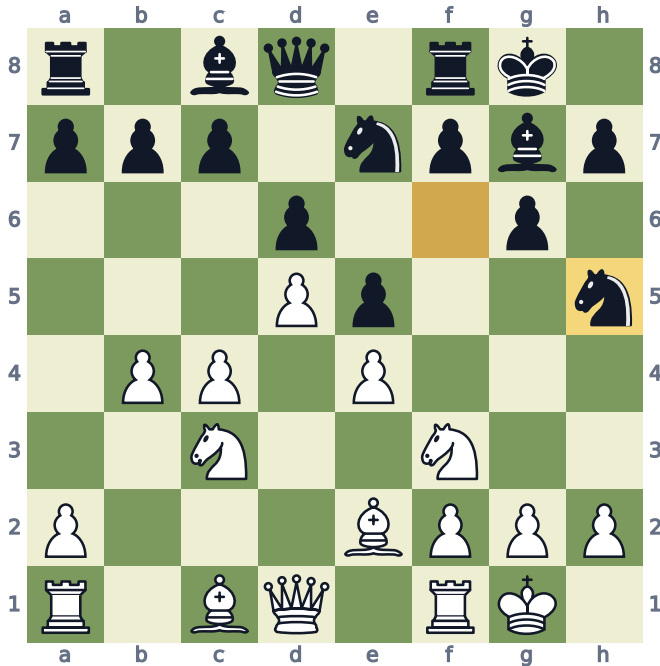
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- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
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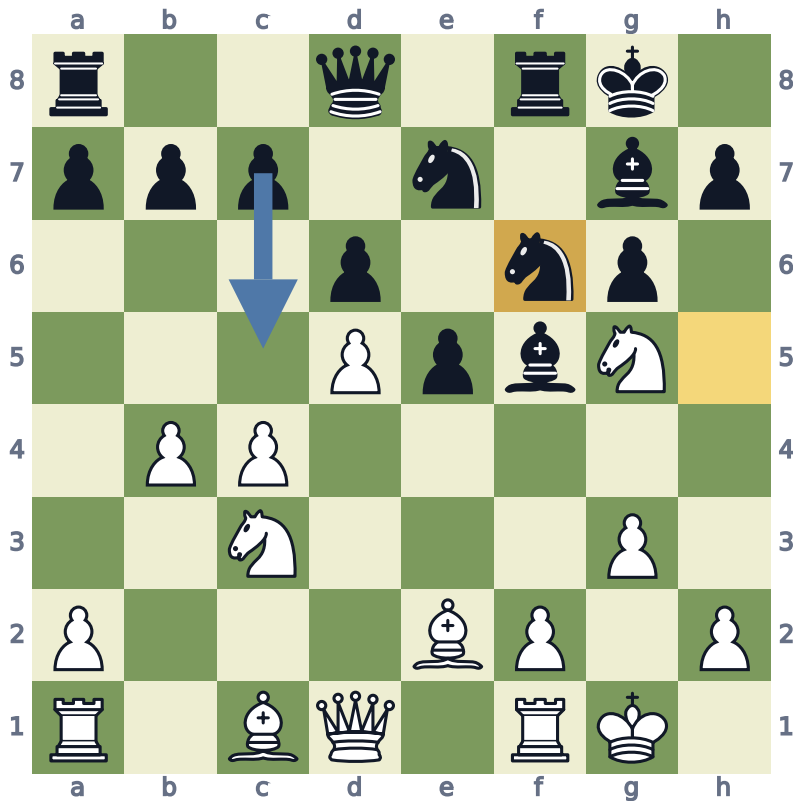
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SIDE TO MOVE

White

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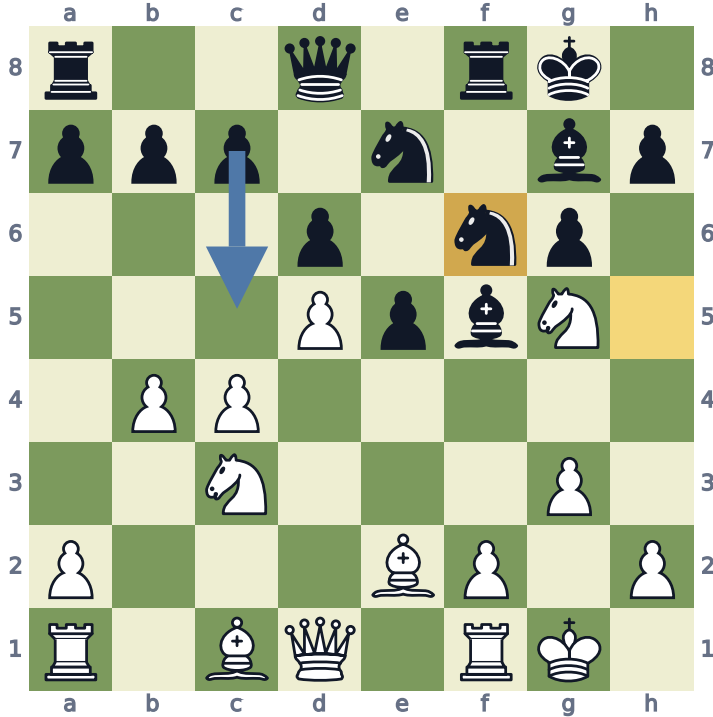
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

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White

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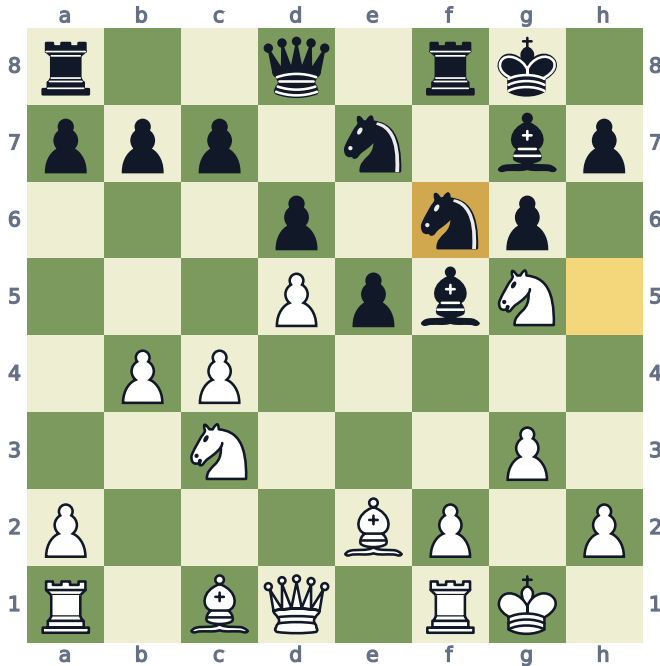
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- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.
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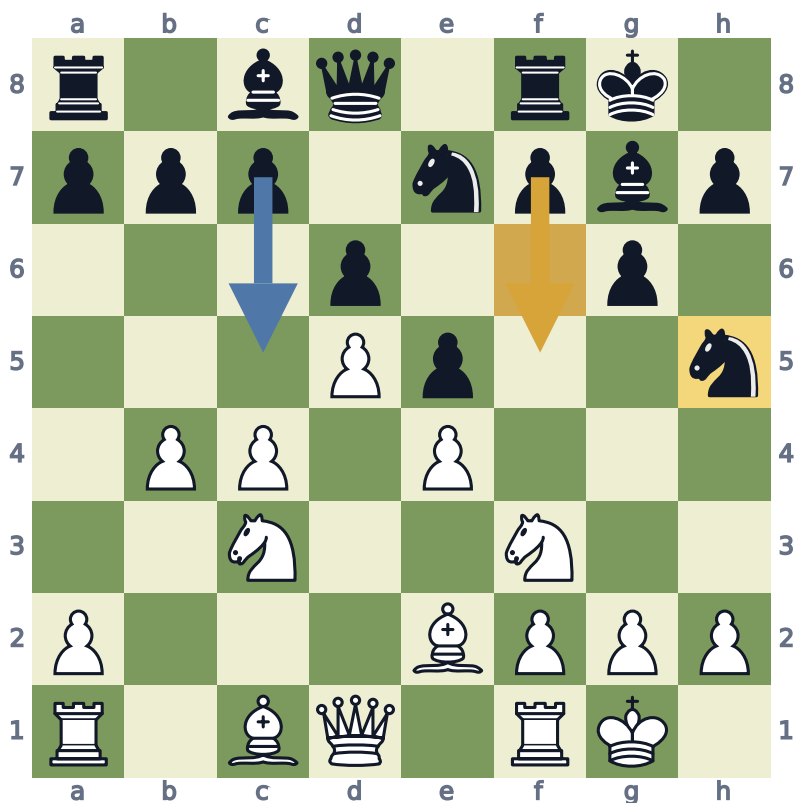
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. g3 f5 11. exf5 Bxf5 12. Ng5 Nf6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The a-file transformation



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...a5 attacks the base of White's expansion and can open the a-file before c5 becomes permanent.

DECISION RULE

Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use the rook actively and pressure c5 or a2 while keeping the kingside break alive.

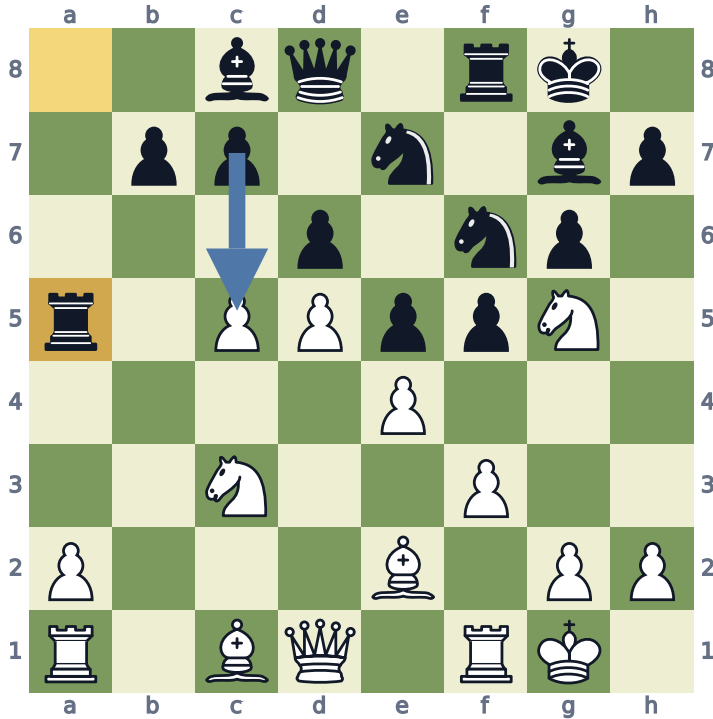
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to stabilize c5, use Nb5, and gain access to d6.

MEMORY RULE | A flank break is justified by the line it opens for a piece.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK AIMS FOR

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White wants to stabilize c5, use Nb5, and gain access to d6.

FAILURE MODE

Opening a file is pointless if only the opponent can enter it.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

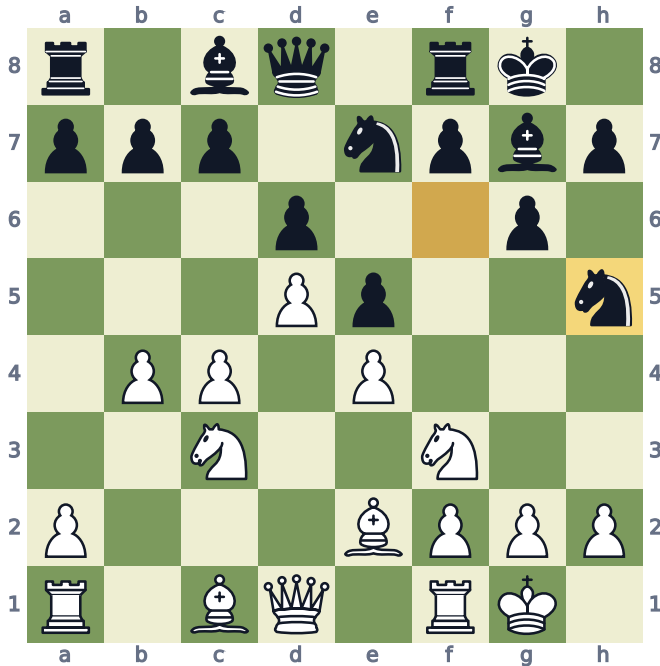
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight toward c6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

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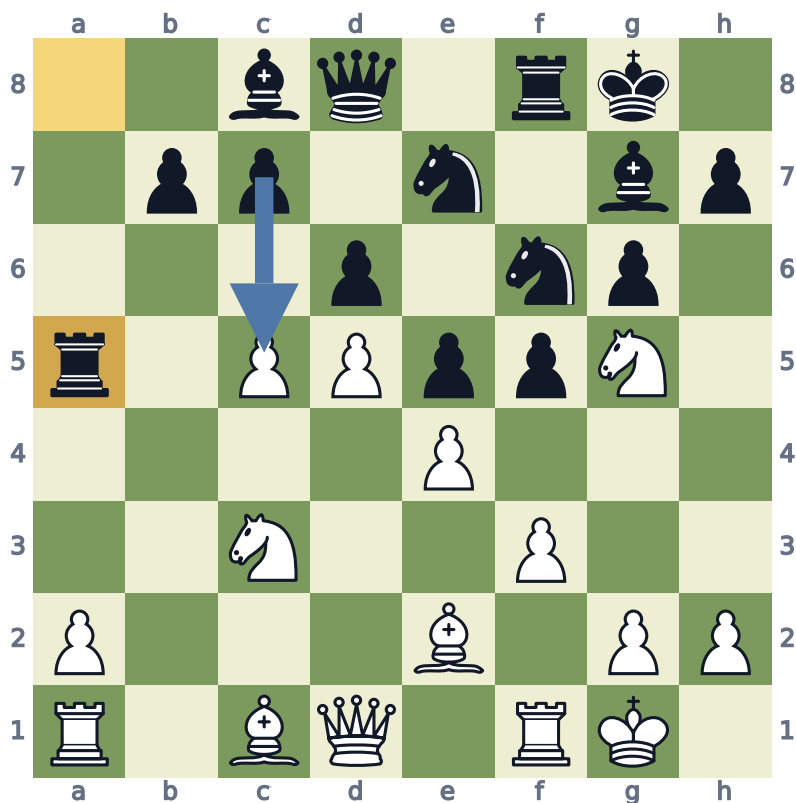
1. ...a5 attacks the base of White's expansion and can open the a-file before c5 becomes permanent. 2. Use the rook actively and pressure c5 or a2 while keeping the kingside break alive. 3. White wants to stabilize c5, use Nb5, and gain access to d6. 4. Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness. 5. Opening a file is pointless if only the opponent can enter it.

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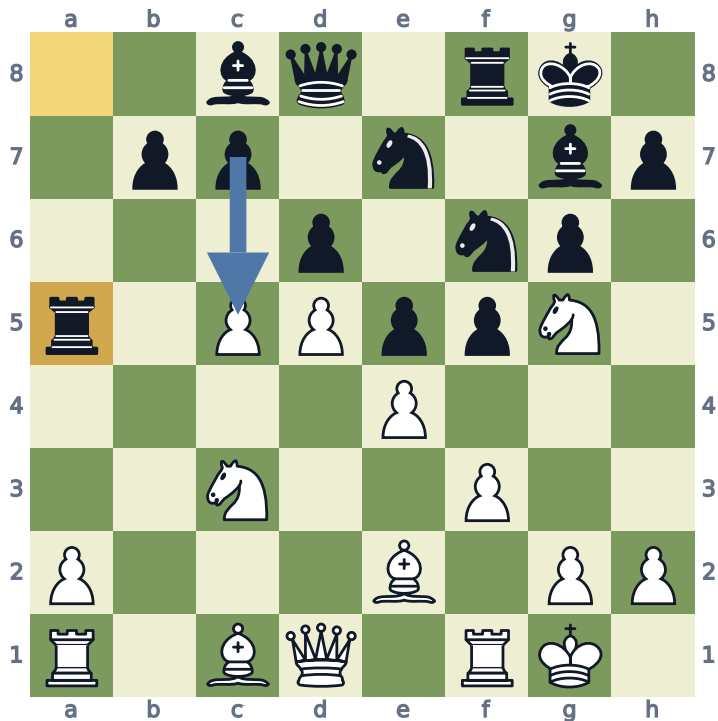
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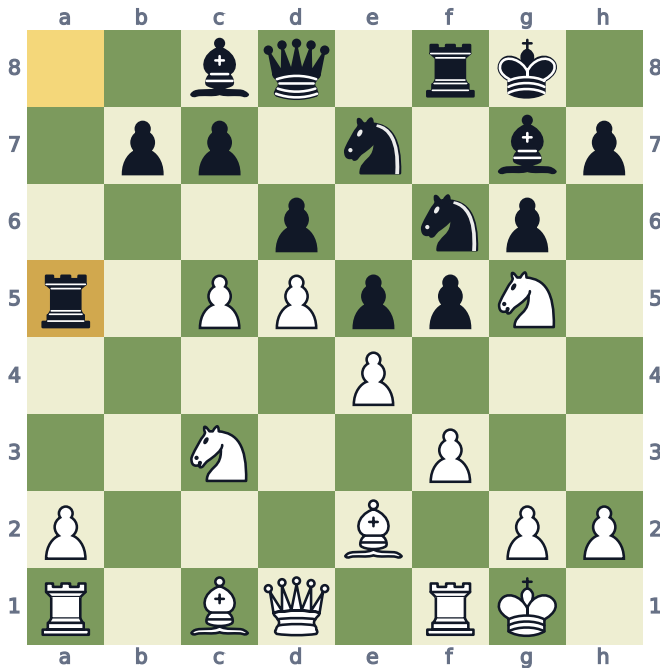
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REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. c5 f5 11. Ng5 Nf6 12. f3 a5 13. bxa5 Rxa5



- Ng5: White reroutes a knight toward g5; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight toward f6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- bxa5: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Rxa5: Black places a rook on a line expected to open or uses it to support a central transformation.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...a5 attacks the base of White's expansion and can open the a-file before c5 becomes permanent.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness. White's resistance is: White wants to stabilize c5, use Nb5, and gain access to d6. The line fails as a template when: Opening a file is pointless if only the opponent can enter it.

STORE THIS | A flank break is justified by the line it opens for a piece.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. ...a5 attacks the base of White's expansion and can open the a-file before c5 becomes permanent. 2. Use the rook actively and pressure c5 or a2 while keeping the kingside break alive. 3. White wants to stabilize c5, use Nb5, and gain access to d6. 4. Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness. 5. Opening a file is pointless if only the opponent can enter it.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 26 plies from memory, then replay: 11. Ng5 Nf6 12. f3 a5 13. bxa5 Rxa5

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 025 Decode: The Nh5 response

Prompt: Test whether ...f5 or ...c6 must come first in the exact move order.

Recall: Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.

LESSON 026 Play: The Nh5 response

Prompt: Test whether ...f5 or ...c6 must come first in the exact move order.

Recall: Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.

LESSON 027 Decode: The capture on f5

Prompt: Compare ...Bxf5 with other recaptures by activity, king safety, and control of e4.

Recall: Evaluate the recapture by the next two useful moves.

LESSON 028 Play: The capture on f5

Prompt: Compare ...Bxf5 with other recaptures by activity, king safety, and control of e4.

Recall: Evaluate the recapture by the next two useful moves.

LESSON 029 Decode: The a-file transformation

Prompt: Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness.

Recall: A flank break is justified by the line it opens for a piece.

LESSON 030 Play: The a-file transformation

Prompt: Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness.

Recall: A flank break is justified by the line it opens for a piece.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The Nh5 response

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. Re1 f5 11. Ng5 Nf6 12. Bf3 c6

Decision: Test whether ...f5 or ...c6 must come first in the exact move order.

Memory: Against the Bayonet, move order is part of the defense.

CARD 2

The capture on f5

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. g3 f5 11. exf5 Bxf5 12. Ng5 Nf6

Decision: Compare ...Bxf5 with other recaptures by activity, king safety, and control of e4.

Memory: Evaluate the recapture by the next two useful moves.

CARD 3

The a-file transformation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. c5 f5 11. Ng5 Nf6 12. f3 a5 13. bxa5 Rxa5

Decision: Calculate whether opening the a-file creates real entry squares or merely trades a pawn weakness.

Memory: A flank break is justified by the line it opens for a piece.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
025 Decode: The Nh5 response	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
026 Play: The Nh5 response	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
027 Decode: The capture on f5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
028 Play: The capture on f5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
029 Decode: The a-file transformation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
030 Play: The a-file transformation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.